Digital Forensic Reporting

Craft an Evidentiary Report for a Digital Forensic Case

Introduction

The final phase of a digital forensic investigation is the reporting of the findings, which should be well organised and presented in a format that the target audience understands.

This tutorial aims to familiarise you with some of the reporting options of Autopsy. Follow the tutorial steps and practise with any case you have created for analysis in any of the practical sessions.

Tagging

Tagging (or Bookmarking) allows you to create a reference to a file or object and easily find it later. When an interesting item is discovered, the user can tag it by right-clicking the item and selecting one of the tag options.

When you tag an artefact, you have the choice to either:

- *Tag File* – use this when the file itself is of interest
- *Tag Result* – use this when the result is of interest

The context of the case and what you need to add in the final report define your choice between Tag File or Tag Result.

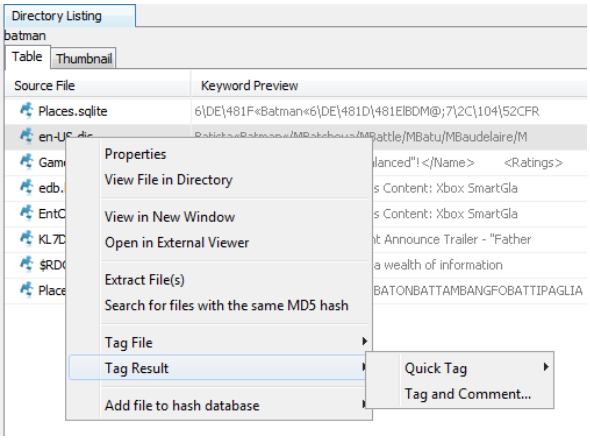

Figure 1: Tagging Options

Once you have chosen to tag the file or the result, there are two ore options:

- *Quick Tag* – use this if you just want the tag
- *Tag and Comment* – use this if you need to add a comment about this tag

You can create arbitrary tag names. Autopsy remembers your tag names from previous cases, so choose wisely. Choose a tag from the list you have created or create a "New Tag".

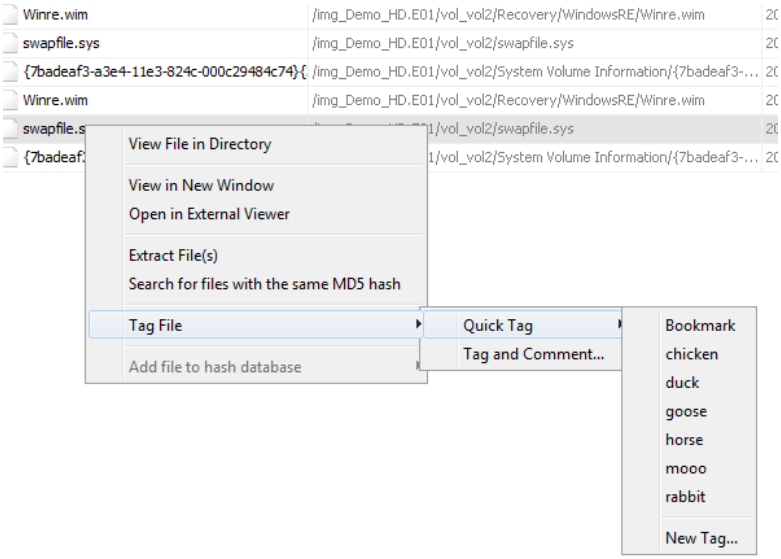

Figure 2: 'New Tag' Option

You can apply tags to groups of items at once. Select multiple items, right click, and add the appropriate tag. Items may have more than one tag.

Tagged results are shown in the "Results" portion of the tree under "Tags".

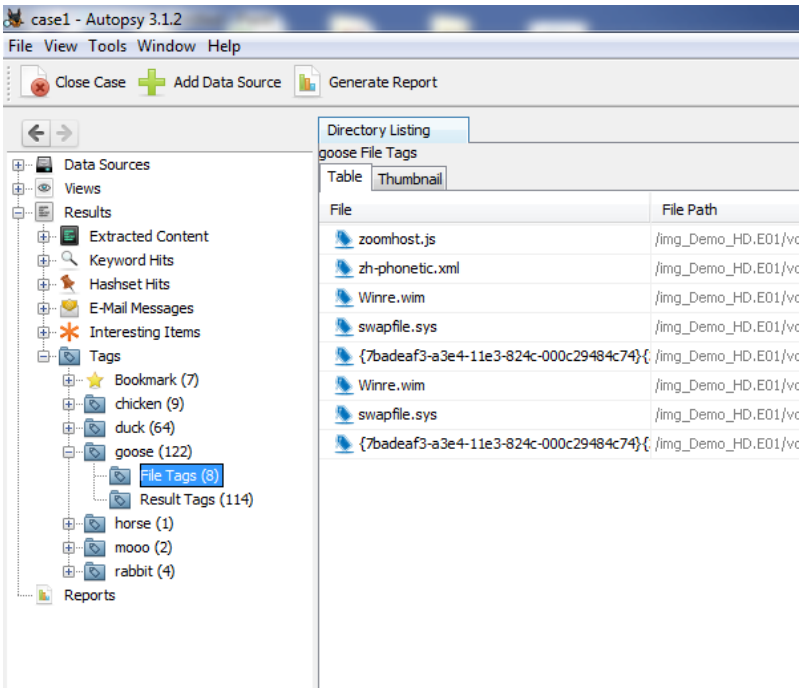

Figure 3: Tagged Results

Reporting

To create a report, go to "Tools", "Generate Report". You can choose several different types of reports. We will go through the HTML report here.

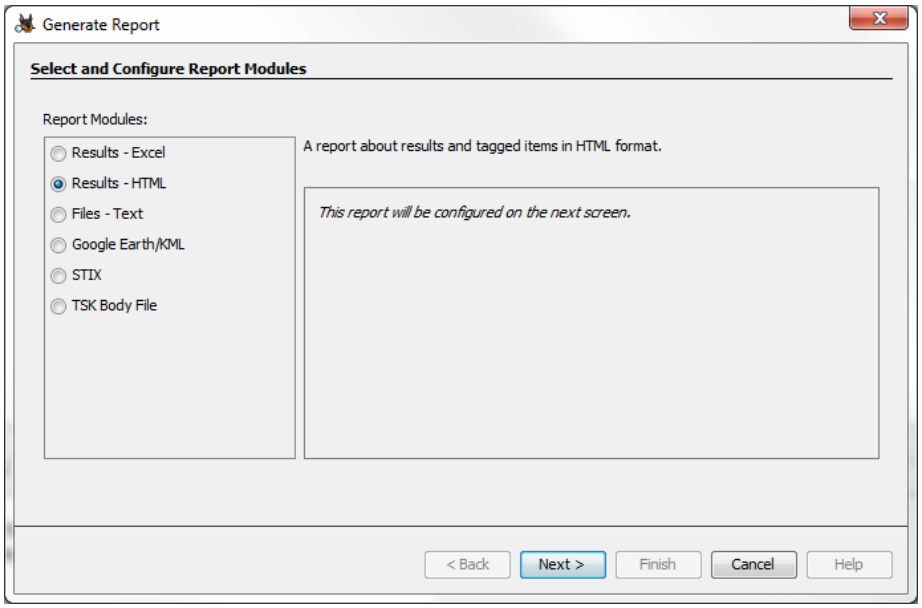

Figure 4: Autopsy 'Generate Report' Menu

When you have selected a report type, choose between

- All Results
- Tagged Results

If you select All Results, you can choose the Data Types (Artifact Types) you would like included.

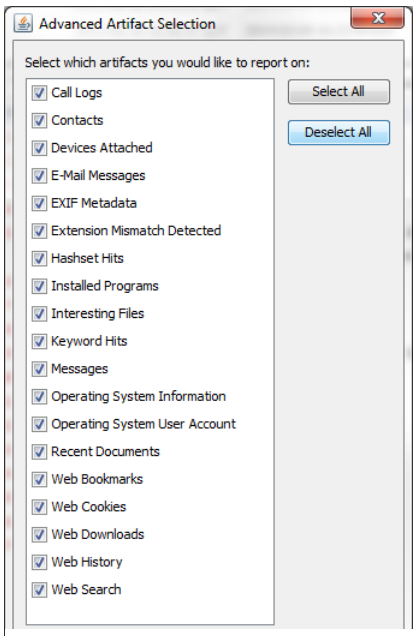

Figure 5: Artifact Selection

If you select Tagged Results, you can choose the tags you would like included.

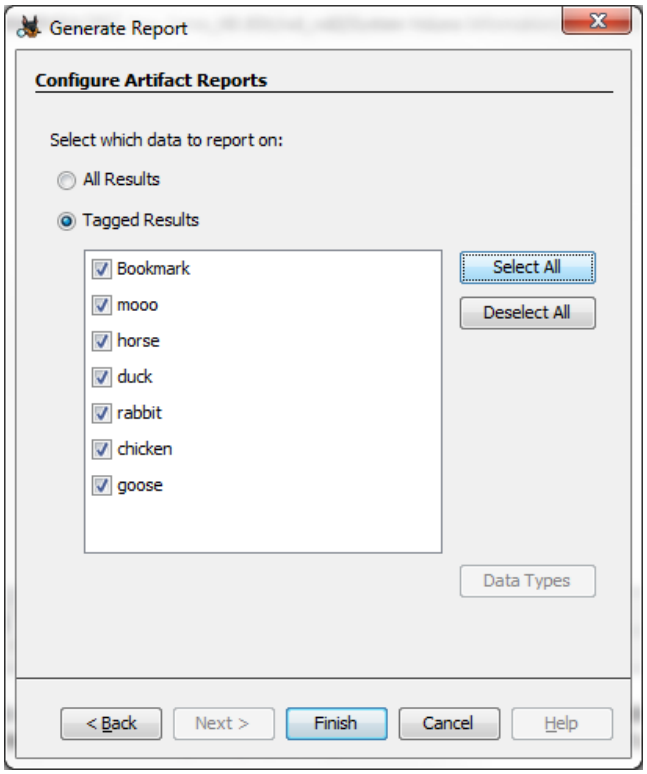

Figure 6: Tagged Results Selection

In our case, an HTML report is generated.

All Results HTML Report:

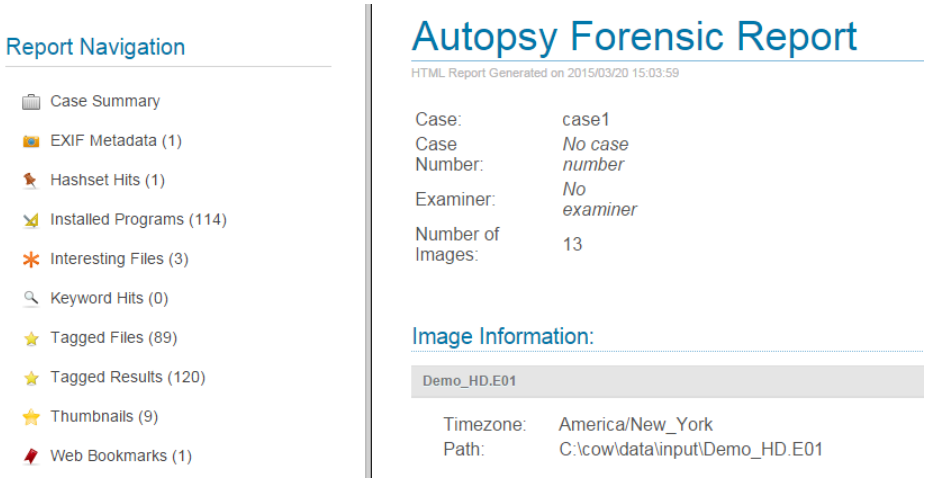

Figure 7: Tagged Results HTML Report

There are other types of reports to choose, but they operate on the same principle. Select either All Results or Tagged results to include.

Task

1. If you did not already do so, use any of the cases you have already worked on in the lab and format the report from that case with Autopsy's report writing feature as described in the previous sections of this tutorial.

2. Add new sections in your report as outlined in the lecture material.

3. Redesign the report layout and practise with new sections and formatting options. You may use the sample reports you were provided with as a template. Explore the reporting options and practise with the output.

Time for this task: 40 minutes

Source: Autopsy User Documentation 4.0, Autopsy User's Guide, https://www.sleuthkit.org/autopsy/docs/user-docs/4.0/